GRADE 8 CREATIVE ARTS AND SPORTS

DETAILED TEACHING NOTES • FULL YEAR • 2027

School: _____ Teacher: _____ TSC No.: _____

Learning Area: Creative Arts and Sports | Grade: 8 | Year: 2027

Curriculum alignment note

These teacher-prepared notes are organised around the Grade 8 Creative Arts and Sports strands and sub-strands in the KICD curriculum design. They explain key concepts and provide practical guidance for teaching and learning. They are supplementary notes, not an official KICD publication. Teachers should use the current curriculum design and approved learner materials when confirming detailed content and assessment expectations.

Optional sub-strand

This set follows the Kenyan Indigenous Game option. The curriculum design also provides Swimming as an alternative optional sub-strand. Schools choosing Swimming must ensure appropriate facilities, qualified supervision, risk assessment and water-safety arrangements.

General safety and inclusion

Use age-appropriate activities, inspect spaces and equipment, provide warm-ups and cool-downs for physical activities, and adapt tasks to learner needs. Use safe materials and tools in art and craft. Respect cultural context, privacy, permissions and the dignity of all learners.

1.0 FOUNDATIONS OF CREATIVE ARTS AND SPORTS

1.1 Roles of Creative Arts and Sports

Meaning of Creative Arts and Sports

Creative Arts and Sports brings together creative expression and physical activity. It includes visual art, music, dance, drama, craft and sport. These activities allow learners to communicate ideas, develop abilities, work with others and participate in community life.

Social roles

Creative Arts and Sports can promote interaction, cooperation, inclusion and social cohesion. Group performances, games and creative projects provide opportunities for people to work towards shared goals, respect different abilities and celebrate community identity.

Cultural roles

Artworks, songs, dances, crafts and games can preserve and communicate cultural knowledge, values, histories and traditions. Learners should explore cultural expressions respectfully and avoid stereotyping or presenting one community as representing all communities.

Health and personal development

Appropriate physical activity supports fitness, coordination and wellbeing. Creative activities can develop imagination, confidence, communication, concentration and problem-solving. Participation should be inclusive, safe and appropriate to learners' abilities.

Economic roles

Creative and sporting activities can provide livelihoods and employment through performance, design, craft production, coaching, event organisation, media, manufacture and related services. They may also support tourism and local enterprise.

Photographic storyboard

A photographic storyboard uses a sequence of images to communicate an idea or show different roles of Creative Arts and Sports. Select images that relate to the message, arrange them in a logical order, prepare a suitable background, add captions where appropriate and present the finished work.

Presentation and appreciation

When displaying a storyboard, explain the message and the choice of images. Viewers should comment respectfully on clarity, sequence, relevance and visual arrangement. Feedback should identify strengths and suggest improvements.

1.2 Components of Creative Arts and Sports

Elements of verse

Verse is a form of creative language arranged in lines and sometimes stanzas. Character refers to a person or figure presented in the verse; theme is the central idea or message; and setting is the time and place in which the events or ideas occur. Sound, rhythm and imagery may also contribute to meaning.

Endurance and agility

Endurance is the ability to sustain physical activity over time. Agility is the ability to change direction or body position quickly and under control. Activities such as running at an appropriate pace, shuttle movements and carefully planned movement drills may develop these components. Learners should warm up, use safe space and work at a suitable level.

Bass staff and ledger lines

The bass clef is used for lower musical pitches. The bass staff has five lines and four spaces. Ledger lines extend the staff when notes are too high or low to fit within it. Learners should practise identifying pitches using the accepted notation system and teacher demonstrations.

Piano keyboard and middle C

The piano keyboard has repeating groups of white and black keys. Middle C is a useful reference pitch near the centre of the keyboard. Learners can relate notes on the staff to keys on the keyboard and observe how pitch rises and falls.

Accidentals

An accidental changes the pitch of a note. The sharp raises a note by a semitone, the flat lowers it by a semitone, and the natural sign cancels an earlier sharp or flat within the relevant notation context. Follow the notation conventions taught in

class.

Note values and 3/4 time

A semibreve, minim, crotchet and pair of quavers represent different durations. In 3/4 time, there are three crotchet beats in a bar. Notes and rests are grouped so that each bar has the correct total duration. Learners should clap, count and write simple patterns.

G major scale

The G major scale uses the pitches G, A, B, C, D, E and F-sharp before returning to G. It can be written on the staff using the correct key signature. Practise reading, singing or playing the scale at a comfortable pace.

2.0 CREATING AND PERFORMING IN CREATIVE ARTS AND SPORTS

2.1 Drawing and Painting

Forms, shapes and composition

A shape is a two-dimensional enclosed area, while a form gives the appearance of three-dimensional volume. A still-life composition arranges objects for observation and drawing or painting. Look carefully at outline, proportion, position, overlap, light and shadow.

Dominance

Dominance is the visual emphasis given to one part of an artwork. It can be created through size, colour, contrast, position, detail or isolation. A dominant feature attracts the viewer's attention and helps organise the composition.

Complementary colours

Complementary colours are opposite one another on a colour wheel. Common pairs include red and green, blue and orange, and yellow and violet. When placed beside one another, they create strong contrast. Mixing complementary colours may reduce their brightness.

Colour wheel and gradation

A colour wheel organises colours to show relationships. A gradation strip shows a gradual change from one value or intensity to another. Learners should mix and apply colour carefully, keeping tools clean and labelling colour samples where required.

Still-life painting process

Observe the arrangement, identify the dominant object, sketch the main forms lightly, check proportions and placement, then apply colour in layers. A thin wash can establish broad areas before details are added. Use complementary colours thoughtfully to create contrast.

Appreciation and care

Display completed work and discuss composition, dominance, colour choice and technique. Give respectful feedback and care for brushes, palettes, paper and other materials. Clean the workspace after the activity.

2.2 Rhythm

Meaning of rhythm

Rhythm is the organisation of sounds and silences in time. It is created through patterns of long and short sounds, beats, accents and rests. Rhythm can be experienced through listening, singing, movement, clapping and playing instruments.

3/4 time

A time signature of 3/4 indicates three crotchet beats in each bar. Count evenly as one, two, three. A rhythm in 3/4 should add up to three crotchet beats or their equivalent note and rest values in every complete bar.

Composing a four-bar rhythm

Choose a steady pulse, select note and rest values, arrange them into four bars and check that each bar contains the correct duration. Keep the pattern clear and suitable for performance. Use notation or another agreed method to record the composition.

Performing rhythm

Clap, tap, stamp or use simple percussion instruments to perform the pattern. Maintain a steady beat, observe rests and coordinate with other performers. Begin slowly and increase speed only when the group can perform accurately.

Evaluation

Listen to the performance and consider pulse, accuracy, coordination, clarity and expression. Give constructive feedback and revise the pattern or performance where necessary.

2.3 Athletics and Montage

Athletics and safe participation

Athletics includes track and field activities. Learners should follow instructions, use suitable clothing and footwear, warm up before activity and cool down afterwards. Check the activity area for hazards and adapt tasks to individual ability.

Running skills

Running involves posture, coordinated arm and leg action, controlled breathing and appropriate stride. Sprinting emphasises rapid acceleration and speed over a short distance, while other running events require pacing and endurance. Starting and finishing techniques should be practised under supervision.

Relay running

Relay events involve team members completing sections of a course and transferring a baton within the designated exchange area. Practise safe handover, communication, timing and running in the correct lane or space.

Field-event safety

Field events require careful control of equipment and the activity area. Only perform the techniques and use equipment specified by the teacher. Learners must wait for instructions before retrieving equipment and remain outside active throwing or landing zones.

Montage

A montage combines images, pictures, textures or other visual elements to communicate a theme or idea. Plan the message, select relevant material, arrange the elements, consider balance and emphasis, then attach or combine them neatly.

Presenting montage work

Explain the theme and how the selected images contribute to it. Review the arrangement for clarity, balance, contrast and visual interest. Display work safely and give respectful feedback.

2.4 Melody

Meaning of melody

A melody is an organised sequence of pitches heard as a musical line. It may move upwards, downwards or repeat notes. Melodies often contain short phrases that can be sung, played or written using musical notation.

Pitch and staff notation

Pitch describes how high or low a sound is. Notes are placed on lines and spaces of a staff. The clef identifies the pitch reference. Learners should practise reading notes and relating them to familiar instruments or vocal sounds.

G major

The G major scale contains G, A, B, C, D, E and F-sharp. Practising the scale supports pitch awareness and melodic reading. Use the correct key signature when writing melodies in G major.

Creating a melody

Choose a small set of pitches, decide on a rhythm, organise the notes into short phrases and check that the melody is singable or playable. A simple melody can use repetition and small variations to create unity and interest.

Performance and appreciation

Perform with accurate pitch, steady rhythm and clear phrasing. Listen to others and describe features such as direction of pitch movement, repetition, phrase length and mood.

2.5 Netball

Purpose and basic organisation

Netball is a team game in which players work together to move the ball and score by shooting through the opponents' goal ring. Each position has an assigned area and role. Learners should know the court layout and basic rules before playing.

Passing and receiving

Passing moves the ball between teammates. Practise chest, shoulder and bounce passes where appropriate. A receiver should watch the ball, present hands and control it safely. Accuracy and communication support effective teamwork.

Footwork, landing and pivoting

Players should land in a balanced position and establish a landing foot according to the rules. Pivoting allows a player to turn while maintaining the correct foot contact. Practise slowly before applying the movement in a game.

Dodging and shooting

Dodging helps a player move into space to receive a pass. Shooting requires balance, focus and controlled arm action. Practise close-range technique before attempting more difficult shots.

Marking and defending

Defenders use positioning, observation and controlled movement to limit passing options without unsafe contact. Respect personal space and follow the rules on obstruction and contact.

Teamwork and fair play

Players communicate, cooperate and respect officials, opponents and teammates. Modified small-sided games allow learners to practise skills and apply rules. Stop play when a learner is injured and follow the teacher's safety instructions.

2.6 Fabric Decoration

Meaning and purpose

Fabric decoration changes the appearance of cloth through colour, pattern, texture or added design. It can be used for personal expression, cultural purposes, household items and products for sale.

Tools and preparation

Tools and materials depend on the technique. Prepare a clean work surface, protect clothing and follow instructions for dyes, paints, stamps and other materials. Use only approved materials and avoid tasting or directly inhaling products.

Tie-dye

Tie-dye uses folding, twisting, tying or binding sections of fabric before applying dye. Bound areas resist some of the dye and create patterns. Follow the product instructions and teacher guidance for mixing, application and rinsing.

Printing and stamping

Printing transfers a design onto fabric using a prepared block, stamp or other suitable tool. Apply colour evenly and press carefully to avoid smudging. Repeat patterns can be planned using spacing and alignment.

Resist methods and pattern planning

A resist prevents colour from reaching selected areas. Learners should plan the design, choose suitable colours and test a small sample where possible. Keep the process orderly and protect the work area.

Finishing and appreciation

Allow decorated fabric to dry and follow care instructions for setting or washing. Display finished samples and discuss pattern, colour, neatness, technique and possible uses.

2.7 Descant Recorder

Parts and care

The descant recorder commonly has a mouthpiece, body sections and finger holes. Assemble and handle it carefully according to the instrument design. Keep it clean and store it safely after use.

Posture and hand position

Sit or stand upright without tension. Hold the recorder gently, with the left hand uppermost and the right hand lower, following the teacher's demonstration. Cover holes fully to avoid unwanted air leaks.

Breathing and tone

Use controlled, gentle breath to produce a clear tone. Excessive breath pressure can make the sound harsh or unstable. Practise starting and stopping notes cleanly.

Fingering and notation

Learn finger patterns gradually and relate them to written notes. Cover holes accurately and move fingers economically. Practise short patterns slowly before combining them into melodies.

Ensemble performance

When playing in a group, listen to others, maintain a steady pulse, begin and end together and follow the conductor or agreed cues. Give feedback on tone, rhythm, posture and coordination.

2.8 Verse

Forms and purpose

Verse uses patterned language and may be arranged in lines and stanzas. It can tell a story, express feelings, describe experiences or communicate ideas. Forms vary in structure and style.

Character, theme and setting

A character is a person or figure represented in the verse. The theme is the central idea or message. Setting refers to the time and place. These elements help the reader understand the situation and meaning.

Language and imagery

Imagery uses descriptive language to create pictures or sensory impressions. Figurative language, repetition and carefully chosen words can strengthen expression. Learners should identify how language choices affect meaning.

Rhythm and sound

Rhythm is the pattern of sound and stress. Rhyme, alliteration and repetition may contribute to sound patterns. Not all verse must rhyme; the writer chooses techniques suited to the intended effect.

Composing and presenting

Plan a theme and setting, decide on a voice or character where appropriate, draft lines, revise word choice and read the work aloud. Present with suitable pace, expression and clarity.

2.9 Volleyball

Game organisation and safety

Volleyball is a team game played across a net. Teams use controlled contacts to send the ball into the opponents' court. Check the playing surface, use suitable equipment and follow the teacher's safety directions.

Ready position and movement

A ready position supports quick movement in different directions. Keep balance, bend knees slightly and watch the ball. Move under control and avoid collisions with other players.

Passing and setting

Underarm passing is commonly used to receive a ball, while overhead passing or setting directs the ball to a teammate. Practise hand position, body alignment and controlled contact.

Serving

A serve starts play by sending the ball over the net from the service area. Practise a safe, controlled serving action and observe the rules demonstrated by the teacher.

Attacking and blocking

An attack attempts to direct the ball into the opponents' court. Blocking is used near the net to stop or deflect an attack. Practise timing and safe movement without contacting the net or another player.

Teamwork and rules

Players communicate, rotate as required and respect the rules and decisions of officials. Modified games provide opportunities to practise skills, fair play and cooperation.

2.10 Kenyan Folk Dance

Meaning and cultural value

Folk dance is a form of dance associated with a community's cultural practices and social life. It may be performed during celebrations, ceremonies, work-related events or community gatherings. Traditions vary across communities and change over time.

Research and respect

When studying Kenyan folk dances, use reliable sources and identify the community and context accurately. Avoid treating a dance as representative of every member of a community. Respect cultural protocols and permissions when recording or presenting material.

Movement and formation

Dance uses body movement, space, timing, levels, direction and formations. Learners can observe repeated movement patterns and practise them safely, maintaining awareness of others.

Rhythm, costume and props

Music or other rhythmic accompaniment may guide movement. Costumes and props can communicate context, but should be handled respectfully and used only when appropriate and available.

Rehearsal and performance

Practise movements in sequence, coordinate with the group and agree on starting and ending cues. A performance may be evaluated for timing, coordination, expression, formation and respectful representation.

2.11 Indigenous Kenyan Craft – Basketry

Basketry and community use

Basketry is the making of containers or other objects by interlacing, plaiting or weaving flexible materials. Baskets may be used for storage, carrying, display and trade. Designs and materials differ across communities.

Materials and sustainability

Fibres may come from locally available plant materials or other suitable sources. Select materials responsibly and avoid harvesting protected or scarce resources. Prepare materials according to the task and teacher guidance.

Tools and safety

Use only suitable tools and demonstrate safe handling. Keep sharp tools under teacher control where necessary. Work in a clean, organised area and protect hands when preparing fibres.

Weaving techniques

Basketry techniques may include coiling, plaiting and interlacing. Begin with a stable base, maintain even tension and build the sides gradually. The chosen technique depends on the material and intended form.

Finishing and appreciation

Secure loose ends, strengthen the rim and inspect the finished item. Discuss function, durability, neatness, pattern and cultural significance. Display work respectfully and care for tools and leftover materials.

2.12.2 Kenyan Indigenous Game (Optional)

Meaning and examples

Indigenous games are games developed or traditionally played within communities. They may involve physical skill, strategy, cooperation, memory or problem-solving. Examples and rules vary between communities and localities.

Cultural and social value

Games can support social interaction, recreation, physical activity and transmission of community knowledge. Research the local name, rules and context of a selected game rather than assuming that one version is universal.

Rules, equipment and space

Agree on the rules before play. Identify the equipment required, boundaries, number of participants and safety precautions. Use safe, locally available substitutes only where they do not create hazards.

Skills and fair play

Practise the movements or strategies required by the game. Encourage inclusion, cooperation, respect and honest application of rules. Modify the game to allow participation by learners with different abilities.

Participation and reflection

Play the selected game under teacher supervision. Afterwards, discuss what skills were used, how the group cooperated and how the game may be adapted while retaining its key features.

3.0 APPRECIATION IN CREATIVE ARTS AND SPORTS

3.1 Analysis of Creative Arts and Sports

Meaning of analysis

Analysis involves observing a creative work or sporting performance carefully, identifying its features and explaining how they contribute to the overall result. It should be based on evidence rather than personal insults or unsupported judgement.

Analysing visual art

Consider subject matter, line, shape, form, colour, texture, space, composition, emphasis and technique. Explain how these features communicate an idea or create an effect.

Analysing music and verse

For music, consider rhythm, melody, pitch, tempo, dynamics, tone and structure. For verse, consider theme, character, setting, imagery, sound patterns and language choices.

Analysing dance and performance

Consider movement, timing, space, formation, coordination, expression, costume and the relationship between performers. Cultural context should be described accurately and respectfully.

Analysing sports performance

Use agreed criteria such as skill execution, control, teamwork, tactics, safety and fair play. Feedback should be specific, constructive and focused on improvement.

Portfolio and reflection

A portfolio collects evidence of learning, such as sketches, written reflections, photographs where permitted, designs and performance records. Learners should explain what they developed, challenges encountered and possible next steps.

REVISION AND APPLICATION QUESTIONS

1. Explain four social or economic roles of Creative Arts and Sports in society.
2. Describe the character, theme and setting in a verse of your choice.
3. Distinguish between endurance and agility and give one suitable activity for each.
4. Explain how notes and rests are grouped in 3/4 time.
5. Describe two ways of creating dominance in a drawing or painting.
6. Explain how a four-bar rhythm in 3/4 time can be composed and performed.
7. State safety precautions to observe during athletics activities.
8. Describe how a montage can communicate a message.
9. Explain how a simple melody can be created using pitches from G major.
10. Describe correct techniques for passing, receiving and shooting in netball.
11. Outline the steps involved in planning and carrying out a fabric-decoration activity.
12. State correct posture, hand position and breathing practices when playing a descant recorder.
13. Explain how character, theme and setting contribute to a verse.
14. Describe the purpose of passing, setting, serving and blocking in volleyball.
15. Explain why Kenyan folk dances should be researched and presented with cultural respect.
16. Describe the basic stages involved in making a simple basket using a suitable weaving technique.
17. Explain how a selected Kenyan indigenous game can be adapted to promote inclusion and fair play.
18. Give criteria that can be used to analyse an artwork, musical performance or sporting activity.

Suggested learner-centred approaches

Use observation, demonstration, guided practice, group creation, rehearsal, performance, practical skill stations, peer feedback, portfolio development and reflection. Link activities to learners' local environments and available resources while respecting cultural context and safety.